Minutes for the January 14, 2026, Vietnam Veterans of America, Chapter 279 Meeting

The regular meeting of Chapter 279 was called to order by Vice President Mangiamelli at 1830 hours. After the salute to the American flag, VP Mangiamelli led the Pledge of Allegiance.

Roll Call of Officers: VP Mangiamelli, Treasurer Haase, Secretary Halbkat. President Hester was excused. There were 3 officers and 36 members. We have a quorum.

Chaplain Dwain Holmes led the Chapter in prayer. His email is: tukupholmes@gmail.com. His phone number is: 402-999-1108. If this is helpful please put it in your contact list in your phone.

Guest Speaker: None

New Members: None

Sick Call: Ron Dupell has family staying with him. Jim Kjosa is going through radiation treatment. Get well, guys, we miss you.

Presidents report: Quilts of Valor Ceremony will be held on Saturday, March 28, 2026 honoring four Chapter members. In February, I will send an email out to see how many members and spouses will attend the Quilts of Valor Ceremony. We had a great 2025. As far as membership goes, we started out the year with 209 members and ended with 223. Outstanding!!!

Secretary Report: There was no meeting in December of 2025. All members with spouses gathered in the dining area to enjoy a potluck dinner and each of the stories told by all of us. We all had stories.

Treasurer Report: Ron Haase explained all the entries made to the report. There were no bills to be paid. George Abbott made motion to accept and Dick Rowe seconded. Motion passed.

Scholarship: None

Veterans Home Board: Tom Brown reports the next meeting will be at Bellevue Veterans Home.

Correspondence Report: VP Mangiamelli read some thank you letters from Bellevue University thanking us for the donation for backpacks for homeless veterans and a letter from Quilts of Valor.

Veterans Court: None

National VVA Delegate Report: Dottie Barickman, our National Treasurer, reports that funding has been cut due to economic reasons. There are now just 33 people working in the building. The next meeting in Washington will give us more information on the end of VVA as we know it.

In the month of March, we will be accepting names for officers to be voted on in April.

Nebraska VVA Foundation Report: Tom Brown reports there will be a new President this month.

Homeless Veterans: None

Chapter Membership Report: 223 members and 12 associates.

POW/MIA: Ron Haase reports 1566 – was 1565

Please check out the chapter's webpage: nebraskavietnamveterans.com

Next Meeting: Wednesday, February 11, 2026 at 1830 hours. Located at the Millard American Legion Post 374.

Motion to adjourn was made by Dick Rowe. Motion passed unanimously.

Submitted by Tom Halbkat, Secretary